Translation standard — the Spanish edition

This sets out how Spanish is handled on the publication. It applies to every Spanish string on the site.

0. The principle everything else follows from

The official texts are the reference point, and their choices are not altered — in representation or in interpretation.

- **Representation.** A quotation is reproduced exactly as the Holy See published it: wording, punctuation, capitalisation, and **emphasis**. We do not tidy it, re-punctuate it, re-emphasise it, or take it out of italics.
- **Interpretation.** A quotation means what the Holy See means by it. We may comment *on* it, but never restate it in our own words and present the restatement as the quotation. No paraphrase inside quotation marks, ever.

Two official texts exist and both are authoritative for their own language:

LANGUAGE	SOURCE
English	`vatican.va/content/leo-xiv/en/encyclicals/documents/20260515-magnifica-humanitas.html`
Spanish	`vatican.va/content/leo-xiv/es/encyclicals/documents/20260515-magnifica-humanitas.html`

The Spanish edition is **not a translation of the English edition**. It is the same document issued in Spanish, with its own settled wording. Where our English page quotes the English edition, our Spanish page quotes the **Spanish edition** — pulled from the Spanish source, never machine-translated from ours.

1. Two kinds of text, two different jobs

	QUOTED MAGISTERIAL TEXT	OUR OWN PROSE
what	sentences of *Magnifica Humanitas*	essay bodies, abstracts, standfirsts, paragraph notes, topic descriptions, summaries
source	the official text, verbatim	written by us, in Spanish
method	**lookup, never translation**	writing, in the register below
latitude	none	full, within the register

The distinction is not stylistic. Translating a papal quotation and presenting it as a quotation attributes wording to the Holy See that the Holy See did not write. On the English side all nine quoted extracts verify as verbatim against the official English; the Spanish must meet the same bar against the official Spanish.

2. Register

Target: the formal preferences of the Holy Father's pastoral region — northern Peru (Chulucanas, Piura; the Diocese of Chiclayo) — used in a general way.

The audience, in order of priority:

1. **The Holy Father.** Robert Francis Prevost became a Peruvian national in 2015, served as a missionary in Piura from 1985, and was Bishop of Chiclayo 2015–2023. Northern Peruvian Spanish is the language of his episcopate — not a stylistic flourish. It should read to him as his own.
2. **Readers from that region**, who should find nothing foreign in the vocabulary.
3. **Spanish readers generally**, who should find nothing parochial.

This is a formal register, not a popular one. The goal is the region's *preferences*, delivered with dignity — the vocabulary a Peruvian bishop would preach in, not the vocabulary of the street. A doctrinal publication is not the place for regional slang, and a reader in Lima should never be able to say the text was written for Chiclayo alone.

2.1 Person and address

- **`usted` throughout**, rather than `vosotros` or `tú`. Formal address is native register here, not stiffness.
- The **first person plural** (`nosotros`) for the Church's own voice, as the official text does: *«debemos recordar»*, *«no podemos limitarnos»*.

2.2 Lexis — the actual regional markers

NOT (PENINSULAR)	USE (PERUVIAN / LATIN AMERICAN)
móvil	**celular**
ordenador	**computadora**
coche	**auto**, **carro**
zumo	**jugo**
vale (as assent)	**está bien**, **de acuerdo**
vosotros	**ustedes**

The regionalism stops at vocabulary: no diminutives in doctrinal prose, no regional idioms, no locally-specific slang.

2.3 Ecclesial vocabulary

Settled by the Holy See's own Spanish, so our terms match the Church's rather than paraphrasing them. See the glossary (`glossary.es.md`) — every entry there is attested in the official Spanish text.

2.4 Names and titles

- The Pope is **León XIV**. (English: *Leo XIV*.)
- ***Magnifica Humanitas*** stays Latin, italic, never translated. The full formal title is *Carta Encíclica de Su Santidad León XIV Magnifica Humanitas*.
- *Rerum novarum* stays Latin, italic.
- Scripture books take the Spanish abbreviations and the Spanish citation convention (below).

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3. Citation conventions differ between the languages

These are **not** interchangeable and each language follows its own published convention.

	ENGLISH	SPANISH
scripture	`Mt 25:14-30` (colon)	`Mt 25,14-30` (**comma**)
paragraph of the encyclical	`MH 107`	**`MH, n. 107`** (`n.` for *número*)
book abbreviations	Mt, Gn, Ne, Pr, Hch	Mt, Gn, Ne, Pr, **Hch**

The `/es/` routes render the Spanish convention. A Spanish page citing "MH 107" would be following the English one.

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4. Emphasis

The official text emphasises words that carry its argument. MH 118:

> En cambio, debemos recordar que el ser humano no florece *a pesar* del límite, sino a menudo *a través* del límite.

The italics on ***a pesar*** and ***a través*** **are the argument** — the reversal from "despite" to "through". Drop them and the sentence still reads; it no longer says what the author said.

The extract field carries inline emphasis as **single asterisks** — `*a pesar*` renders as *a pesar* — and English and Spanish each carry their own, so the two editions cannot drift into one another.

Emphasis in the official Spanish text falls in these quoted paragraphs:

PARAGRAPH	EMPHASISED SPANS IN THE OFFICIAL SPANISH
MH 4	*rerum novarum*
MH 9	*Mt*
MH 89	*Hch*
MH 118	***a pesar***, ***a través***

Emphasis is reproduced as the Holy See set it, and not added: italicising a quotation the Holy See did not italicise would emphasise on the Pope's behalf — the same error in reverse.

(For whoever maintains the site: `doc_paragraphs.extract` is localized, and `site/src/lib/emphasis.ts` escapes `& < > "` before expanding `*…*`, so quoted text cannot inject markup and an unpaired `*` stays literal. Resolved 2026-10-06.)

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5. Reviewing a Spanish draft

- ☐ Every quotation matches the official Spanish edition **character for character**, emphasis included.
- ☐ Every quotation traces to the **Spanish** source, not to a translation of our English.
- ☐ No paraphrase appears inside quotation marks.
- ☐ Terminology follows `glossary.es.md`.
- ☐ `usted` throughout, not `vosotros`.
- ☐ No Peninsular lexis from the table in §2.2.
- ☐ Citations use the Spanish convention (§3).
- ☐ *Magnifica Humanitas* untranslated and italic.
- ☐ Read the whole piece once end to end — sentence-level swaps inside long paragraphs leave dangling connectors that no checklist catches.